

The Rose Surface: Discrete Onsager–Machlup, Dial Graphs, and a Program for Data-Driven Statistical Dynamics

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Contents

1	Rose kernels and dials	2
1.1	Product-form kernels and minimal assumptions	2
1.2	Local-linear residual construction (canonical example)	3
1.3	Scaled kernels and notation for the rest of the paper	3
1.4	Neutral (reversible) Rose operator	3
2	Population theory	3
2.1	CGF $\Rightarrow$ Fisher $\Rightarrow$ Landau	3
2.2	Dirichlet energy as common source	4
2.3	Fisher–curvature–entropy bridge	4
2.4	Discrete Onsager–Machlup functional	5
2.5	Deterministic limit and least-action equivalence	5
2.6	Introducing the dial plane	6
2.7	Edge-wise dial oracle	6
2.8	Global KL gradient corollary	7
3	Finite-sample dial selection	7
3.1	Goldenshluger–Lepski selector	7
4	Directed curvature and reversibility diagnostics	8
4.1	Curvature proxy on the dial graph	8
4.2	Irreversibility measure via antisymmetric current	8
5	Historical Survey of Discrete Onsager–Machlup	9
	TODO write narrative	9
6	Proofs for Main Theorems	9

6.1	Proof of Proposition 2.1	9
6.2	Proof of Theorem 2.1	9
6.3	Proof of Theorem 2.2	9
7	Finite-Sample Theory	9
7.1	Goldenshluger–Lepski Oracle Inequality	9
7.2	Synthetic and Real-Data Experiments	9
8	Dial-Graph Geometry	9
8.1	Directed Discrete Curvature	9
8.2	Helmholtz Decomposition and Fisher Clock	9
9	Programmatic Directions	9
10	Concluding Outlook	9

Guide to the two-layer release

- A) Main Letter (12–15 pp)** Appears separately as *Geometry, Entropy, and Operator Learning with Tunable Kernels*. It contains the core bridge theorem, KL = least-action, and one synthetic experiment.
- B) This Program Paper (full version)** Provides historical survey §1, proofs, extended risk analysis, dial-graph curvature, and open problems (Sections 2–7 below).

To avoid duplication: we load the Letter as an external file, then append the expanded material.

1 Rose kernels and dials

1.1 Product-form kernels and minimal assumptions

$$z := y - x, \quad r := \|z\|.$$

(W1) **(Radial weight)** $w : [0, \infty) \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ is C^1 , radial, $\int_{\mathbb{R}^d} w(\|z\|) dz = 1$, $\int \|z\|^2 w(\|z\|) dz < \infty$, and $w \in L^2(\mathbb{R}^d)$.

(W2) **(Centred residual)** $g : \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow [0, \infty)$ is C^1 , $\int g(z) dz = 1$, $\int z g(z) dz = 0$, $\int z z^\top g(z) dz < \infty$, and $\nabla g \in L^2(\mathbb{R}^d)$.

Definition 1.1 (Rose kernel). For $(\theta, \sigma) \in (0, \infty)^2$ set

$$w_\theta(r) := \theta^{-d} w(r/\theta), \quad g_\sigma(z) := \sigma^{-d} g(z/\sigma), \quad k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) := \frac{w_\theta(\|x - y\|) g_\sigma(y - x)}{\int_X w_\theta(\|x - y'\|) g_\sigma(y' - x) dy'}$$

Lemma 1.1 (Normalisation and basic bounds). Under Assumptions (W1)–(W2) the expression in Definition 1.1 defines a measurable Markov transition density $k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x)$:

$$0 \leq k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) \leq \frac{w_\theta(\|x - y\|) g_\sigma(y - x)}{\inf_x Z_{\theta,\sigma}(x)}, \quad \int_X k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) d\mu(y) = 1,$$

where $Z_{\theta,\sigma}(x)$ is the denominator in Definition 1.1 and satisfies $0 < \inf_x Z_{\theta,\sigma}(x) \leq \sup_x Z_{\theta,\sigma}(x) < \infty$.

(K1) (Markov) $k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) \geq 0$ and $\int_X k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) dy = 1$.

(K2) (Score in L^2) $S_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) := \nabla_y \log k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) \in L^2(dy dx)$.

(K3) (Second-moment scaling) $\int_X \|y - x\|^2 k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) dy = O(\theta^2)$ as $\theta \downarrow 0$.

(K4) (C^1 in dials) $\partial_\theta \log k_{\theta,\sigma}, \partial_\sigma \log k_{\theta,\sigma} \in L^2(dy dx)$.

1.2 Local–linear residual construction (canonical example)

1.3 Scaled kernels and notation for the rest of the paper

1.4 Neutral (reversible) Rose operator

- Define $k^\natural(y | x) = \frac{1}{2}[k(y | x) + k(x | y)]$.
- Self-adjoint $\mathcal{R}^\natural$; serves as equilibrium baseline.

2 Population theory

(K0)–(K2) as in Sec. 3.0 — Markov, score L^2 , second-moment scaling.

2.1 CGF $\Rightarrow$ Fisher $\Rightarrow$ Landau

Definition 2.1 (One-step CGF).

Definition 2.2 (Symmetric Fisher load). Given a Rose kernel $k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x)$ with score $S_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) := \nabla_y \log k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x)$ and anchor/target measures μ_0, μ_1 , define for $f \in W^{1,2}(X, \mu)$

$$\mathcal{I}_{\theta,\sigma}[f] := \iint_{X \times X} \langle \nabla f(y), S_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) \rangle^2 d\mu_0(x) d\mu_1(y).$$

Similarly, for a density $\rho \ll \mu$,

$$\mathcal{I}_{\theta,\sigma}[\rho] := \iint_{X \times X} \langle \nabla \log \rho(y), S_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) \rangle^2 d\mu_0(x) d\mu_1(y).$$

Proposition 2.1 (CGF–Fisher correspondence). *For every $(\theta, \sigma) \in (0, \infty)^2$ and every centred observable $f \in W^{1,2}(X, \mu)$,*

$$\Lambda_{\theta,\sigma}(\lambda; f) = \frac{\lambda^2}{2} \mathcal{I}_{\theta,\sigma}[f] + O(\lambda^3), \quad \lambda \rightarrow 0,$$

where $\mathcal{I}_{\theta,\sigma}[f] = \iint \langle \nabla f(y), S_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) \rangle^2 d\mu_0(x) d\mu_1(y)$.

Remark 2.1 (Legendre dual = Landau stiffness). A two–line box reminding readers that the Legendre transform of Λ yields a quadratic Landau free energy.

2.2 Dirichlet energy as common source

Definition 2.3 (Symmetrised kernel and Dirichlet form). Let $k_{\theta,\sigma}^{\natural}(y | x) := \frac{1}{2}(k_{\theta,\sigma}(y | x) + k_{\theta,\sigma}(x | y))$ and let $\mu_{\natural}$ be any reference measure absolutely continuous w.r.t. both μ_0 and μ_1 (often $\mu_{\natural} = \frac{1}{2}(\mu_0 + \mu_1)$). Define the associated Dirichlet form

$$\mathcal{E}_{\theta,\sigma}(f) := \frac{1}{2} \iint_{X \times X} (f(y) - f(x))^2 k_{\theta,\sigma}^{\natural}(y | x) d\mu_{\natural}(x) d\mu_{\natural}(y).$$

Lemma 2.1 (Fisher load from Dirichlet energy). *Under Assumptions (K1)–(K3), there exists a dial-dependent coefficient $c_{\theta,\sigma} > 0$ such that*

$$\mathcal{I}_{\theta,\sigma}[f] = c_{\theta,\sigma} \mathcal{E}_{\theta,\sigma}(f) + o(1) \quad (\theta \downarrow 0),$$

with $c_{\theta,\sigma} = 4/\theta^2 + o(\theta^{-2})$ in the isotropic small-locality regime.

Remark: Reversible baseline and operator split

2.3 Fisher–curvature–entropy bridge

Lemma 2.2 (Iterated carré–du–champ). *Under Assumptions (K1)–(K3), for every $f \in W^{1,2}(X, \mu)$,*

$$\Gamma_2^{(\theta,\sigma)}(f) = \frac{\theta^2}{2} \mathcal{I}_{\theta,\sigma}[f] + o(\theta^2), \quad \theta \downarrow 0.$$

Lemma 2.3 (Discrete de Bruijn Identity). *Fix $\theta > 0$. For every density $\rho \ll \mu$ with $\mathcal{I}_{\theta,\sigma}[\rho] < \infty$,*

$$\frac{d}{d\sigma} H(R_{\theta,\sigma}^{\sharp} \rho) = -\frac{1}{2} \mathcal{I}_{\theta,\sigma}[\rho], \quad \sigma > 0.$$

Theorem 2.1 (Fisher–curvature–entropy bridge). *With Assumptions (K1)–(K3),*

$$\boxed{\mathcal{I}_{\theta,\sigma} = \frac{2}{\theta^2} \Gamma_2^{(\theta,\sigma)} = -2 \frac{d}{d\sigma} H(R_{\theta,\sigma}^\# \rho)} + o(1).$$

Corollary 2.1 (Discrete fluctuation–dissipation). *Combine Lemma 2.2 and Lemma 2.3. In the small–locality regime $\theta \downarrow 0$, the response coefficient obtained by differentiating the one–step entropy $H(R_{\theta,\sigma}^\# \rho)$ w.r.t. the noise dial σ equals (up to the universal factor $2/\theta^2$) the curvature prefactor $\Gamma_2^{(\theta,\sigma)}(f)$, i.e.*

$$\frac{d}{d\sigma} H(R_{\theta,\sigma}^\# \rho) = -\frac{1}{\theta^2} \Gamma_2^{(\theta,\sigma)}(f) + o(1).$$

Thus fluctuations (Fisher load) determine dissipation (entropy production) in exact analogy with the Onsager reciprocal relations.

2.4 Discrete Onsager–Machlup functional

Corollary 2.2 (Discrete OM action). *Let $\mathbf{x} = (x_0, \dots, x_n)$ be a trajectory sampled every h and let $k_{\theta,\sigma}$ satisfy (K0)–(K2). With local drift m_θ and quadratic forms $\Gamma_t^2 := \Gamma_2^{(\theta,\sigma)}(f_t)$, $\dot{H}_t := \partial_\sigma H(R_{\theta,\sigma}^\# \rho_t)$,*

$$\mathcal{A}_{\theta,\sigma}[\mathbf{x}] = \frac{1}{\theta^2} \sum_t \Gamma_t^2 - \frac{1}{\sigma^2} \sum_t \dot{H}_t + o(1)$$

as $(\theta, \sigma) \downarrow 0$. If $k = k^\natural$ and $\sigma^2 = 2Dh$ with $h \rightarrow 0$, this reduces to the classical continuous Onsager–Machlup functional.

Remark 2.2 (Data-driven OM). Any consistent drift estimate (e.g. LWLS–1) may replace m_θ without changing the quadratic structure of $\mathcal{A}_{\theta,\sigma}[\mathbf{x}]$.

2.5 Deterministic limit and least–action equivalence

Remark 2.3 (Classical Lagrangian limit). In the joint limit $\theta, h \rightarrow 0$ with $\sigma^2 = 2Dh$, the discrete action density converges to $\frac{1}{4D} \int_0^T \|\dot{x}(t) - b(x(t))\|^2 dt$, the standard Onsager–Machlup Lagrangian for diffusions.

Theorem 2.2 (KL–least–action equivalence). *For every Rose kernel $k_{\theta,\sigma}$ let*

$$J(\theta, \sigma) := \text{KL}(\mu_1 \parallel k_{\theta,\sigma} \# \mu_0), \quad \mathcal{A}_{\theta,\sigma}^{\text{pop}} := \mathbb{E}_{\mu_0} [\mathcal{A}_{\theta,\sigma}[X_{0:n}]]$$

denote, respectively, the population Kullback–Leibler functional and the population Onsager–Machlup action introduced in Corollary 2.2. Under Assumptions (K0)–(K3)

$$\boxed{\nabla_{(\theta,\sigma)} J = \nabla_{(\theta,\sigma)} \mathcal{A}_{\theta,\sigma}^{\text{pop}}} \quad \text{for all } (\theta, \sigma) \in (0, \infty)^2.$$

Remark 2.4. The pair

$$(\theta^*, \sigma^*) := \arg \min_{(\theta, \sigma)} J(\theta, \sigma) = \arg \min_{(\theta, \sigma)} \mathcal{A}_{\theta, \sigma}^{\text{pop}}$$

maximises the likelihood of the observed path ensemble within the two-dial Rose family; equivalently, it minimises the expected Onsager–Machlup action. Hence trajectories generated under the little-rose kernel are the most probable (in the maximum-likelihood sense) among all trajectories that can be produced by Rose kernels.

2.6 Introducing the dial plane

(K4) C^1 regularity in dials. $(\theta, \sigma) \mapsto \log k_{\theta, \sigma}$ is C^1 and $\partial_\theta \log k_{\theta, \sigma}, \partial_\sigma \log k_{\theta, \sigma} \in L^2(d\mu_0 d\mu_1)$.

2.7 Edge-wise dial oracle

Oracle axioms

- (A1) Reversibility consistency.** If $k(y | x) = k(x | y)$ then $\mathcal{O}(x_i, x_j) = \mathcal{O}(x_j, x_i)$.
- (A2) Permutation equivariance.** $\mathcal{O}(\pi(i), \pi(j)) = \mathcal{O}(x_i, x_j)$ for any permutation π .
- (A3) Strict-convex minimal risk.** $\mathcal{O}(x_i, x_j) = \arg \min_{(\theta, \sigma)} \mathcal{J}_{ij}(\theta, \sigma)$ with $\mathcal{J}$ strictly convex.
- (A4) Positive empirical mass.** Empirical anchor weights satisfy $\inf_{i \in V} \hat{\mu}_0(i) > 0$.

Definition 2.4 (Edge KL functional). Given observed transitions from anchor x_i , let $\hat{k}_{ij}$ denote the empirical conditional probability that a step from x_i lands in x_j . Define the edge-wise KL at dials (θ, σ) :

$$\mathcal{J}_{ij}(\theta, \sigma) := \sum_j \hat{k}_{ij} \log \frac{\hat{k}_{ij}}{k_{\theta, \sigma}(x_j | x_i)}.$$

(For continuous X , replace the sum by an integral against the empirical conditional measure $\hat{k}_i$.)

Proposition 2.2 (Edge-wise KL gradient). *For every ordered pair (x_i, x_j) and all (θ, σ) ,*

$$\nabla_{(\theta, \sigma)} \mathcal{J}_{ij}(\theta, \sigma) = -\frac{1}{2} \nabla_{(\theta, \sigma)} \mathcal{I}_{ij}(\theta, \sigma).$$

Consequently the oracle dials $(\theta_{ij}^, \sigma_{ij}^*)$ maximise the Fisher load and minimise the edge-wise KL.*

Definition 2.5 (Little-rose operator). Assign each edge its oracle dials $(\theta_{ij}^*, \sigma_{ij}^*)$ and denote by $\mathcal{R}_\star^{b/\#}$ the resulting pull-back and push-forward operators. We call this pair the *little-rose operator*.

2.8 Global KL gradient corollary

Corollary 2.3 (Global KL gradient). *Summing Proposition 2.2 over all edges with weights $\mu_0(i)$ yields*

$$\nabla_{(\theta, \sigma)} \text{KL}(\mu_1 \parallel k_{\theta, \sigma} \# \mu_0) = -\frac{1}{2} \nabla_{(\theta, \sigma)} \mathcal{I}_{\theta, \sigma},$$

hence the little-rose operator is the unique minimiser of KL and maximiser of the Fisher load.

3 Finite-sample dial selection

3.1 Goldenshluger–Lepski selector

Lemma 3.1 (Bias–variance decomposition). *For either PF or Koopman risk,*

$$\mathbb{E} \widehat{\mathcal{R}}^\square(\theta, \sigma) = \text{Bias}_\square^2(\theta, \sigma) + \text{Var}_\square(\theta, \sigma),$$

where the bias term is the squared L^2 distance between the population Rose operator at (θ, σ) and the “oracle” operator that best fits the data class, and the variance term scales as

$$\text{Var}_\square(\theta, \sigma) \lesssim \frac{\text{trace}(\Sigma_{\theta, \sigma}^\square)}{n_{\text{eff}}(\theta)},$$

with an effective sample size $n_{\text{eff}}(\theta)$ determined by the local weight w_θ (see Appendix ??).

Theorem 3.1 (GL selector: non-asymptotic risk). *Let $\widehat{\theta}, \widehat{\sigma}$ be chosen by the GL rule with penalty parameter α . Then with probability at least $1 - \delta$,*

$$\mathcal{R}(\widehat{\theta}, \widehat{\sigma}) \leq C_\alpha \inf_{(\theta, \sigma) \in \mathcal{G}} \mathcal{R}(\theta, \sigma) + C \frac{\log(1/\delta)}{n},$$

where $\mathcal{R}$ denotes either PF or Koopman L^2 -risk and C_α, C are explicit constants (see Appendix ??).

Definition 3.1 (Sample risks). Let $\widehat{R}_{\theta, \sigma}^\#$ and $\widehat{R}_{\theta, \sigma}^b$ denote the empirical PF and Koopman estimators built from the sample. Given a test class $\mathcal{F} \subset L^2(X, \mu)$ and $\mathcal{P} \subset L^1(X, \mu)$ define

$$\widehat{\mathcal{R}}^{\text{PF}}(\theta, \sigma) := \sup_{\rho \in \mathcal{P}} \|\widehat{R}_{\theta, \sigma}^\# \rho - R_{\theta, \sigma}^\# \rho\|_{L^2}^2, \quad \widehat{\mathcal{R}}^{\text{K}}(\theta, \sigma) := \sup_{f \in \mathcal{F}} \|\widehat{R}_{\theta, \sigma}^b f - R_{\theta, \sigma}^b f\|_{L^2}^2.$$

4 Directed curvature and reversibility diagnostics

4.1 Curvature proxy on the dial graph

4.2 Irreversibility measure via antisymmetric current

Definition 4.1 (Antisymmetric weight & current). For a Rose kernel $k_{\theta,\sigma}$ define the log-ratio antisymmetry

$$A_{ij} := \frac{1}{2} \left(\log k_{\theta,\sigma}(x_j | x_i) - \log k_{\theta,\sigma}(x_i | x_j) \right)$$

Given a reference mass $\pi_i > 0$ on vertices (e.g. stationary or empirical mass), the probability current is

$$J_{ij} := \pi_i k_{\theta,\sigma}(x_j | x_i) - \pi_j k_{\theta,\sigma}(x_i | x_j),$$

satisfying $J_{ij} = -J_{ji}$. Detailed balance holds iff all $A_{ij} = 0$ (equivalently $J_{ij} = 0$).

Lemma 4.1 (Graph Helmholtz split). *Let J be an antisymmetric edge flow on a finite connected graph (V, E) with vertex weights π . Then there exists a potential $\phi : V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ and a cycle flow $h \in \ker B^\top$ (where B is the weighted incidence matrix) such that*

$$J_{ij} = \pi_i k_{ij}^{\natural} (\phi_j - \phi_i) + h_{ij},$$

with $\sum_j \pi_i k_{ij}^{\natural} (\phi_j - \phi_i) = 0$ at stationarity. The decomposition is unique up to an additive constant in ϕ . Moreover $h = 0$ iff detailed balance holds.

Remark 4.1 (Loschmidt symmetry and the Fisher clock). Setting every antisymmetric weight to zero, $A_{ij} = 0$, collapses the kernel to its neutral form $k^{\natural}$ and makes the Rose operator exactly time-reversal symmetric, matching Loschmidt's objection to irreversible entropy growth.

Turning on any $A \neq 0$ injects a directed cycle curvature $F = \sum_{\text{cycle}} A$, and the Fisher-curvature-entropy bridge (Thm. 2.1) yields

$$F = \frac{1}{2} \mathcal{I}_{\theta,\sigma} = \text{entropy production per step.}$$

A non-zero curvature therefore acts as an intrinsic *Fisher clock*—time emerges only once detailed balance is broken. In the Loschmidt-symmetric limit $A \rightarrow 0$ the clock halts and the macroscopic arrow of time disappears.

5 Historical Survey of Discrete Onsager–Machlup

6 Proofs for Main Theorems

6.1 Proof of Proposition 2.1

6.2 Proof of Theorem 2.1

6.3 Proof of Theorem 2.2

7 Finite-Sample Theory

7.1 Goldenshluger–Lepski Oracle Inequality

7.2 Synthetic and Real-Data Experiments

8 Dial-Graph Geometry

8.1 Directed Discrete Curvature

8.2 Helmholtz Decomposition and Fisher Clock

9 Programmatic Directions

P1 ****Intrinsic Fisher Clocks**** in out-of-equilibrium networks.

P2 ****Multiparameter Persistent Homology**** for dial graphs.

P3 ****Generalised GENERIC Operators**** on rough data manifolds.

10 Concluding Outlook